

segment. The majority of MediaTek's shipments are 2.5G and 2.75G chipsets for the company's low-cost solution. TI has been gradually stepping out of the 2.5G and 2.75G chipset market since the end of 2008, with shipments expected to decline in 2010 and virtually cease in 2012.

The total revenue from handset Bluetooth, GPS and Wi-Fi chipsets is forecast to grow more than 15 per cent this year, and estimated to hit \$3.5 billion in 2015.

Ultra-mobile device IC shipments to surpass 1.24 billion in 2015

Ultra-mobile devices (UMDs) encompass media tablets, netbooks, mobile Internet devices and eBook readers, and together these comprise one of the fastest-growing consumer product markets in the world. All these products need ICs and, according to the latest ABI Research forecasts, this demand could result in shipments of nearly one-and-a-quarter billion ICs in 2015.

However, the forecast for UMD ICs hinges on one factor that is still unknown: whether the media tablet market would perform as expected. Media tablets are potentially very important but still very new, and the ultimate size of their market will in turn determine the demand for these ICs. "If the tablet market meets or exceeds our expectations, then UMD IC shipments should surpass 1.24 billion in 2015," said principal analyst Peter Cooney.

Android-based tablets to outshine iPad

Over 15 suppliers will be selling Android-based tablets by mid 2011. These will include the likes of Acer, Cisco, Dell, Motorola, OpenPeak, Samsung, Viewsonic and many more.

IMS Research forecasts that Android will grow its share of the market from a projected 15.2 per cent in 2011 to 28.4 per cent in 2015. The availability of Samsung's Galaxy Tab tablet via mobile carriers such as AT&T in the US will quickly boost Google Android's presence in

the tablet market. Even in the fixed-broadband Internet service provider (ISP) market, where the interface is typically customised to integrate the ISP's brand and services into the user interface, hardware suppliers are offering Android models to allow ISPs to benefit from the quickly growing Android ecosystem.

Interest in mobile applications building in Asia

Annual mobile application downloads will continue to increase and peak in 2013, with Asia becoming a key market. With North America and Europe slowly reaching maturity after experiencing a period of high growth, emerging countries in the Asian market are expected to take the spotlight.

ABI Research forecasts that application downloads in Asia-Pacific will experience a compound annual growth rate of early 30 per cent, with growth in application revenues of just over 20 per cent, during the period 2009-15. iOS and Android handset owners currently account for 75 per cent of total application downloads and these are expected to continue leading the market until 2015.

"We are getting more announcements of 3G networks about to launch commercially in Asian countries such as India, and more smartphones being shipped to Asia. This will prime these large untapped markets for mobile application downloads," said Fei Feng Seet, research associate with ABI Research.

Telecom equipment manufacturing a big opportunity

The growth of the mobile telephone industry and overall industrial development will fuel the demand for telecom equipment in India.

Last fiscal year, the telecom equipment market in India grew by 18.6 per cent, with overall revenue at Rs 1368 billion. The enterprise equipment segment grew by 31 per cent to touch Rs 200 billion. The switch and router segments registered 92 per cent and 65

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